

Change orders — how to use them

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What a change order is for

Any time the client changes something after the job is sold — a different finish, a different door, an added item — make a change order (CO). The CO keeps four things in sync automatically: the price, the paperwork, the shop specs, and QuickBooks. No side deals, no sticky notes.

Where to find it

Open the project → open the subproject → hit the **Change order** button at the top. To see every CO across all jobs: **Sales** → **Change Orders**.

One form, two modes

Spec change — the change is something already in the estimate (door style, material, finish, drawers). Pick what's changing and pick the new option. The price difference calculates itself from the job's quantities. Need a material we've never used? "+ Add new" saves it to the rate book for next time.

Custom — anything else: a client-supplied item, a vendor price change, a one-off. Type what it is, add material lines and labor hours. The form suggests the client price with our margin built in — you can edit it. Custom items never go into the rate book.

Free change (\$0)

- 1 **Set the price to \$0** — only for true no-cost swaps. If it costs us more, we bill it.
- 2 **Hit "Create & apply"** — the change applies to the job immediately.
- 3 **What happens** — specs update, a new approval card opens (the client still signs off on the actual sample), and the drawing-revision flag shows if you checked it. No invoice is created — the CO record and its PDF are the paper trail.

Priced change

- 1 **Create as draft** — nothing touches the job yet.
- 2 **Send** — emails/downloads the CO PDF for the client. Status: Sent.
- 3 **Client says yes** — by email or verbally. You hit **Accept**. (Or **Decline** if they pass.)
- 4 **Now it applies** — specs update, approval card opens, drawing flag shows — same as a free change.
- 5 **Billing** — the CO goes on its own CO invoice — the original contract invoice never changes. More accepted COs stack onto that same invoice.
- 6 **Push to QuickBooks** — hit **Push to QuickBooks** when you're ready. Once pushed, that invoice is locked — the next CO starts a fresh one. Pushed invoices show "✓ In QuickBooks" with a link.

Reading the money

The project page shows **Project price + Approved change orders = Contract total**. Unpaid CO invoices show as outstanding. If a CO batch works out to a negative number (we owe the client), the app tells you to issue a credit memo in QuickBooks by hand.

Rules of thumb

- **One change per CO**. New door AND new finish = two COs. They stack on the same invoice, so it's painless.
- **The contract invoice is frozen**. Changes never edit it — they ride on CO invoices.
- **Nothing applies until Accept** (priced) — so the shop never builds an unapproved change.
- **Drawings don't update themselves**. The CO flags the revision; a person makes it.
- **A CO on a job already in production shows a big red warning**. That's rare and it's a big deal — talk before you accept it.
- **Every document lives in one place**: the project's Documents section (estimate, invoices, CO PDFs, Drive links).